

EVALUATION AND ACCREDITATION DOCUMENTS

Bachelor in English Language

College of Arts

Jouf University

Sakakah, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

January 2026

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International evaluation and accreditation

EVALUATION REPORT

Bachelor in English Language

College of Arts

Jouf University

Sakakah, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

October 2025

The Jouv University has mandated the Hcéres to perform the evaluation of its Bachelor of English Language programme. The evaluation is based on the “External Evaluation Standards” of foreign study programmes, adopted by the Hcéres Board on September 18th 2024. These standards are available on the Hcéres website ([hceres.fr](https://www.hceres.fr)).

In the name of the expert committee¹:

Annick Rivens, President of the committee

In the name of Hcéres¹:

Coralie Chevallier, President

The High Council for Evaluation of Research and Higher Education (Hcéres) is an independent public authority. It is responsible for evaluating higher education and research institutions, research organisations, research units, and training programmes.

¹In accordance with articles R. 114-15 and R. 114-10 of the Research Code, evaluation reports are signed by the chairman of the expert committee and countersigned by the President of Hcéres.

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I. STUDY PROGRAMME IDENTITY SHEET

- University/institution: Jouf University
- Component, faculty or department concerned: College of Arts, Department of English
- Programme's title: Bachelor in English Language
- Training/speciality: English Language
- Year of creation and context: 2007
- Site(s) where the programme is taught (Town and campus): Sakakah, Jouf University main Campus and Female Campus.

PROGRAMME DIRECTOR

- Dr. Mamdouh Alhuwaykim
- Assistant professor (Programme coordinator)
- Linguistics PhD

METHODS AND RESULTS OF THE PREVIOUS ACCREDITATION(S)

External evaluations by the Saudi National Commission for Academic Accreditation and Evaluation (NCAAA) and The National Center for Assessment (Qiyas) : latest cycle 2021/2022.

HUMAN RESOURCES DEDICATED TO THE PROGRAMME

– Human resource:

Teaching staff: the teaching staff of the BA is mainly composed of 37 permanent faculty members, subject to yearly adjustments. All permanent faculty members hold a PhD, from various institutions, mainly foreign universities.

Team Status	Male	Female	Total
Teaching Assistant	1	2	3
Lecturer	9	17	26
Assistant Professor	17	12	29
Associate Professor	3	2	5
Full Professor	3	0	3
PhD holders	23	14	37
Total	33	33	66

Administrative and technical staff: the BA in English Language is supported by the administrative and technical staff of Jouf University and of the College of Arts. Main services are provided at the level of the university (registration, career centre, student support...). The College of Arts and the Department of English provides the BA with 13 full-time staff, 7 male and 6 female.

– Material resources:

The English programme relies on the material resources provided by Jouf university and the College of Arts. All resources are duplicated on female and male campuses (the female campus is located in the city centre, and the male campus on the outskirts). These resources include:

- 14 rooms in male site and 13 in female site, all are well-equipped with smart screens or projector
- Two libraries (male and female), with both on-shelf and online resources
- Computer labs and lobbies
- Campus facilities such as cafeteria, recreation facilities and a sport centre, bank.

The BA is also equipped in digital resources, the learning management system use for class is Blackboard, the University also have Student Information System to tracks student and managing student grades. Finally, Share-Point serve as the central platform for quality assurance.

STUDENT POPULATION: EVOLUTION AND TYPOLOGY OVER THE LAST 4 YEARS, INCLUDING NUMBER OF GRADUATES

		2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026
Year 1	Male	36	21	15
	Female	42	56	24
	Total	78	77	39
Year 2	Male	39	32	13
	Female	83	58	43
	Total	122	90	56
Year 3	Male	64	27	14
	Female	114	54	31
	Total	178	81	45
Year 4	Male	60	37	15
	Female	122	81	33
	Total	182	118	48
Total	Male	199	117	57
	Female	361	191	131
	Total	560	308	188

II. COMPOSITION OF THE EXPERTS PANEL

Chair:

- Dr Annick Rivens, full professor at Lille University.

Experts:

- Dr Thomas Constantinesco, full professor at Sorbonne University.
- Dr Greta Komur-Thillo, full professor at Haute-Alsace University.
- Dr Kim-Thao Lê, PhD, Paris Nanterre University.

Hcéres was represented by Bastien Torres, project manager, Europe and International Department.

III. EVALUATION PROCESS

VISIT DESCRIPTION

- Date of the visit: 21/09/2025 – 22/09/2025
- Summary of the proceedings: Prior to the visit, the experts received the self-evaluation report and many annexes. During the on-site visit, the panel met with more than 30 stakeholders over two days according to the schedule below. The report was written by the panel chair based on the experts' feedback and then circulated to all panel members for review.
- Organisation of the visit: See schedule below.
- Cooperation of study programme and institution to be accredited: Jouv University provided full access to the two campuses and relevant documents, and the people met during the site visit answered all questions from the panel.
- Any problems: No.

PEOPLE MET

Date	Hour	Interviews
21 September 2025	9:00 - 9:30	Opening session with top management
	9:30 – 10:30	Presentation of the Programme & Discussion
	11:00 – 12:30	Programme Teaching staff, representative panel of professors from the programme
	14 :30 – 15 :30	Alumni & Employers of the programme
22 September 2025	9:00 – 10:00	Quality assurance - Evaluation & Academic Accreditation representatives
	10:00 – 11:00	Student panel: meeting with a representative panel of students from the programme
	12:00 – 13:00	Closing session: discussion with the Dean and the programme coordinator

IV. OVERALL PRESENTATION

1 – PRESENTATION OF THE STUDY PROGRAMME

The Bachelor of English Language programme was established in 2007 in the College of Administrative Science and Humanities and transferred to the College of Arts in 2018. It aims to prepare graduates for careers in English teaching, translation, tourism, and administration, while fostering advanced language competencies and intercultural awareness. Its objectives are aligned with the mission of the College and University, focusing on the development of critical thinking, communication, and interpersonal skills, the production of qualified graduates, and the strengthening of social partnerships.

The programme is structured with core and elective courses, practical training, and internship credits that respond to labor market requirements and international standards. The programme undergoes periodic review every four years, ensuring alignment with the Saudi National Qualifications Framework, and international benchmarks, such as the University of Southampton.

Interdisciplinary collaboration, particularly with Arabic studies, supports bilingual proficiency and cultural awareness. Partnerships with King AbdulAziz Specialist Hospital, and new agreements with International Development Program - International English Language Testing System (IDP IELTS) and the Translation Association in Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA), provide practical engagement opportunities.

The newly revised study plan (24-07-2024) integrates elective courses linked to *Learning and Communication Skills*, *Entrepreneurship*, *Principles of Project Management*, and *Principles of Financial Knowledge*. The programme also conducts training activities and community initiatives that promote sustainable development, as the self-evaluation report indicates.

2 - PRESENTATION OF THE PROGRAMME'S SELF-EVALUATION APPROACH

The self-evaluation of this programme, conducted as part of the external review, was carried out to a very high standard by Jouf University. It is worth noting that the drafting of the self-evaluation report was completed particularly swiftly by the teams, most likely facilitated by the robust internal quality assurance processes in place within the Bachelor's programme. The report followed the Hcéres framework, structured around the four fields, and was written in a clear and effective manner. Importantly, the document was enriched with numerous appendices providing supporting evidence to the evaluation committee. During the visit, the discussions were straightforward and productive, enabling the committee to gain a clearer understanding of the programme. Jouf University also submitted additional supporting documents promptly following the visit.

V. EVALUATION REPORT

FIELD 1- TEACHING POLICY AND CHARACTERISATION

The Bachelor of English at Jouf University is fully aligned with the University's strategic priorities and reflects, through its teaching policy, the University's emphasis on quality, excellence, and graduate employability, while demonstrating its identity as an English Studies programme through consistent disciplinary coverage. The programme's learning objectives (PLOs) are explicitly derived from the graduate attributes identified by Jouf University as core learning priorities in terms of knowledge, skills, and values. By aligning its teaching guidelines and policies with the overall standards that the University ambitions to promote and implement, the programme contributes to realising Jouf University's strategic priorities. The PLOs are also consistent with the Saudi National Qualifications Framework, ensuring coherence with the national higher education landscape. By enabling students to acquire proficiency in English as a transferable skill-set, the programme further contributes to reducing the nationally identified skills gap, thus advancing the goals of Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030. However, both Vision 2030 and Jouf University also emphasise sustainable development as a strategic priority. While the programme addresses this question in several individual courses to raise student awareness, sustainable development is not yet presented as part of the programme's thematic priorities. This could be all the more relevant given the importance of agriculture in the Jouf region and the increasing need to combine economic growth with ecological concerns nationally and globally. Foregrounding environmental humanities literacy as part of the programme's learning priorities might contribute to aligning even better the programme's characterisation with local and national priorities.

The programme is clearly structured and identifiable as an English Studies programme through its broad and progressive coverage of the main expected subfields and disciplines of English Studies. Its learning outcomes and study plans are therefore comparable to similar programmes in other Saudi Universities as well as internationally, with distributed emphasis on language acquisition, linguistics, translation, and literature, thus guaranteeing curriculum balance and consistency. Nevertheless, the programme could benefit from nurturing stronger connexions with other English Studies programmes nationally, beyond the mere purposes of benchmarking, to counter its relative isolation within Saudi higher education. This could take the form of faculty or student exchanges, joint symposiums on dedicated research areas, or inter-university faculty workshops on teaching practices.

Institutional transformations currently under way within the College of Arts and the University constitute both a set of opportunities and a series of challenges for the programme's ability to further develop its own internal consistency, as well complementarily with other study programmes at Jouf University. For instance, the project of creating a Department of Tourism and Archaeology within the College of Arts represents a promising opportunity for strengthening inter-departmental and cross-programme ties in the College, especially in connection with the University-wide project of creating dual degrees and Majors/Minors, insofar as tourism is already a career prospect sought out by students and graduates of the programme. Similarly, the proximity of the College of Education could enable the programme to assert more visibly teacher training as one of its educational priorities.

The programme occupies a strategic position within the College of Arts and across the University at a time when the demand for English courses in other departments and Colleges is growing. This facilitates indeed the programme's integration within the College of Arts and the University, since some of its staff is already called upon to provide English-language courses for students of other disciplines. At the same time, this situation might pose a challenge for the programme's identity in the future if outside demand for English-language courses continues to grow. The creation of a separate Language Learning Centre, catering to other Departments' and Colleges' needs for the teaching of English to specialists of other disciplines, might enable the programme to maintain its characterisation as an English studies programme, while limiting its involvement in the teaching of English as a foreign language in other Departments and Colleges.

The programme adequately positions itself in relation to the international training landscape through the experience of several of its staff members. 35% of the teaching staff are PhD holders, who acquired their degree outside of Saudi Arabia, whether in the United States, the United Kingdom, or Australia (e.g., Indiana Bloomington, Lancaster, Canberra). By harnessing the international training of its staff, the programme ensures that its teaching policies and organisational structure reflect international standards. The diversity of the teaching staff in terms of nationalities, academic background, and training is evidently one of the programme's main assets, as is Jouf University's policy of supporting the further training of newly recruited teaching staff by providing scholarships to enable them to pursue postgraduate and doctoral studies abroad before returning to the Department of English. The University's long-term recruitment plan thus ensures the high quality of its teaching staff.

However, the programme does not yet sufficiently invest in opportunities for international cooperation to expand its international reach for the benefit of students and staff members. To that end, staff members could be encouraged to leverage their professional networks and interpersonal contacts in the institutions abroad in which they were enrolled for their MA and/or PhD, in order to nurture collaborations and thereby provide added value to the programme. Likewise, the development of existing or emerging international partnerships—for example, with the University of Southampton in the UK or with the University of Malaya in Malaysia—should be fostered, especially to provide opportunities for students to spend, for instance, one semester abroad as part of their curriculum, or for staff to benefit from Visiting Professorship schemes. Additionally, new partnerships might be developed at a lower cost with many European institutions, emulating the model of the Erasmus programme within the European Union. While the programme welcomes international students through its admissions procedures (e.g., from countries such as Jordan or Egypt) and trains its graduates to seek further study abroad after the completion of their degree, and while national strategies exist to enable student transfer to other Saudi Universities, the programme's study plan does not incorporate enough possibilities for students to study abroad as part of their Bachelor and gain credits with partner institutions (i.e., outgoing student mobility). Similarly, the programme does not seem to have policies and structures in place to welcome outside students (whether national or international) for one or two semesters as part of their own course of studies in their home institutions (i.e., incoming student mobility). Although institutional and financial challenges are not to be underestimated, strengthening student mobility, both incoming and outgoing, would increase the programme's national and international profile, in line with the University's ambition to enhance international partnerships.

The programme demonstrates that its learning outcomes benefit from research through the research output of several members of its teaching staff. Students are introduced to the stakes and methodologies of academic research through dedicated courses devoted to research methods, through participating in research projects led by their professors, through co-authoring academic papers and articles with their professors, and through developing individual and collective projects as part of course assessment plans. The study programme also includes training in research integrity and ethics through the use of plagiarism detection softwares for all written assessments uploaded on Blackboard. In addition, students benefit from a wide range of digital library resources dedicated to research in the core disciplines of the programme (e.g., Web of Science, Scopus). Print copies of library holdings, however, at least on the male campus main library, are mostly dedicated to language learning and linguistics, at the relative expense of literature and literary/critical theory. While more literature books are held on the female campus, the programme could benefit from a more dynamic resource acquisitions policy on the part of the University library to enhance student training.

The study programme is attuned to the needs of the local and national job markets, so that students receive adequate training to pursue their career goals. In addition to proficiency in English, students of the programme are trained to develop critical thinking, as well as analytical, writing and communication skills, which enhances their employability. The study plan also includes a mandatory internship over at least a semester, which facilitates graduates' insertion into the job market. The programme is even going beyond national requirements in this respect, by now offering students the possibility to extend their internship up to a year. The main career prospects available to graduates of the programme are in education, translation, and tourism, which aligns with the programme's teaching priorities and learning outcomes. The programme involves employers through participation in the Advisory board, thus ensuring that it continuously maintains close links with the economic sector. However, the programme could benefit from foregrounding more explicitly available career opportunities and future prospects through the structure of its study plan. In its current form, the study plan includes three interrelated tracks (Linguistics, Translation, and Literature) which together foster broad and transferable competencies, yet do not fully map onto the main career prospects available upon graduation (Teaching, Translation, Tourism). Clarifying potential career tracks (e.g., Teaching, Translation, Tourism) may enable a stronger articulation between the PLOs and the programme's work-linked training. Doing so might help students identify earlier on in their course of study their preferred career prospects. Furthermore, many graduates of the programme pursue, or intend to pursue, their studies with an MA in English, so that the programme is geared simultaneously towards immediate job-seeking and further study. Adding a track dedicated to introducing students to research in order to prepare their transition towards MA programmes might also help clarify the study programme's structure in relation to the next steps students might take after graduation.

Overall, the teaching policy and learning objectives of the study programme are clearly aligned with the institution's strategic priorities of developing student skills to improve employability and career prospects, as well as to enable graduates to pursue further study at the postgraduate level. The Bachelor of English convincingly demonstrates its disciplinary identity as an English studies programme and leverages the experience of the teaching staff to reflect international standards. It could however benefit from strengthening and expanding its international dimension through collaborations and partnerships to enable student and staff mobility. Additionally, the programme maintains close links with the local economic sector, while introducing students to research methodologies, thus preparing them to enrol in MA programmes, should they wish to do so. The programme could nevertheless benefit from identifying more clearly thematic or professional tracks to facilitate

students' career choice. Current and future institutional changes at the level of the College and the University represent opportunities of expansion for the programme through the development of English-language courses for students of other disciplines, as well as challenges to maintain its characterization as an English Studies programme.

FIELD 2 – PEDAGOGICAL ORGANISATION OF THE STUDY PROGRAMME

The programme is clearly and convincingly structured to meet the target skills and the pedagogical progression across the eight semesters of study is clearly known to both staff members and enrolled students. The study programme's objectives and educational contents are defined and implemented to ensure students' progression. Course levels and pre-requisites are clearly specified, and the sequencing of courses prevents mismatches between expected competencies and students' ability to meet them. The academic mentoring system, implemented from the first semester onwards, ensures that students are provided with appropriate guidance when choosing their courses, while maintaining flexibility by allowing early registration in advanced courses when justified by student performance. One area of improvement in this respect, however, might be translation classes, with some students reporting that the entry level for these courses often felt too high: a more progressive introduction to the discipline of translation, and to the critical vocabulary and techniques involved in the practice of translation, might facilitate the meeting of learning outcomes. More generally, while the programme is geared towards ensuring student success, it might benefit from a more robust set of procedures better to attend to failing students and address their needs. It is true that recruitment procedures, requiring applicants to meet set standards, minimise the risks of students failing to meet the various course requirements. It is also true that the allocation of one academic mentor to each student for a ratio of 1:6 or 7 ensures that no student will be left behind. Yet, the implementation of a new national platform for the allocation of student cohorts to public Universities and programmes across the country may pose a challenge, as Jouf University no longer selects its own students, but entrusts a national body with this task. The perpetuation of this new recruitment policy might be an opportunity for the programme to engage in a broader reflection about best practices to put in place in case of students failing the course.

The programme structure enables solid disciplinary coverage in language acquisition, linguistics, translation, and literature. It also enables the progressive specialisation of students in their career paths through a wide range of elective courses. Nevertheless, these pathways are not explicitly identified as tracks, meaning that specialisation currently results from individual choices made under the guidance of academic advisors. While this supple structure evidently fosters flexibility, it relies too much on individual advice and interpersonal relations and might benefit from being organised at the level of the programme, with a structure reflecting possible specialisations, especially from semester 5 onwards. The balance between specialisation and flexibility is never easy to find, but the programme could do more to identify existing pathways within the study plan to improve the articulation between the curriculum and the career prospects that it enables. At the same time, the introduction of Major/Minor schemes in the near future will contribute to facilitating bridges between programmes to foster flexibility and enable students to change study programmes, should they wish to do so.

The programme's objectives in terms of knowledge and skills to be acquired are made known to the students and other stakeholders through the student handbook, which is available on different platforms, including the Department's website and Blackboard. Discussions with staff members and students of the programme during the on-site committee's visit confirmed that the information contained in the handbook (curriculum organisation and progression, learning and skills objectives, assessment methods) is not only comprehensive, but also familiar to all stakeholders of the programme.

The programme offers a variety of courses in the main sub-disciplines of English Studies (language acquisition, linguistics, translation, literature). Many of these rely on diverse teaching methods, including lectures, collaborative tools, project-based teaching, student group work, and language lab work, to foster student success. However, the programme does not yet include inverted teaching and reverse pedagogy, which may be a modality of learning experience that the teaching staff might want to invest to further diversify the programme's teaching methods and foster student responsibility and autonomy in the learning process. Likewise, the programme could make better use of partial distance learning tools to foster language acquisition and student autonomy. While the programme does not offer refresher courses, it relies on individual mentoring to promote student success and makes use of Blackboard to monitor closely student progress and offer additional support to students when appropriate. The programme also satisfactorily trains students in the use of information and communication technologies through University-mandated computer-skills courses and additional courses in computer-assisted translation.

As an English Studies degree, the programme develops English-language proficiency as a core employability skill, while also preparing students for academic study within or beyond Saudi Arabia. Dedicated workshops train students for national and international language certifications, including the *Jahezia Standardised Exit Exam*,

IELTS, and TOEFL. In doing so, the programme also enables students to acquire additional skills relevant to their job-market integration. The programme might nonetheless consider the following improvements:

- 1) Introducing additional foreign language options, such as French, Spanish, Turkish, or Urdu, to broaden student's linguistic and intercultural competencies; and
- 2) integrating a mandatory national or international English language test during the fourth-year to provide formal qualification/certification of linguistic proficiency as part of the BA degree.

Furthermore, the programme could do more to prepare students for both incoming and outgoing mobility, as already noted in Field 1 above. Outgoing mobility within the programme concerns few students and institutional structures to enable student mobility are yet under-developed, whereas most of the teaching staff have an international background, with networks and connections abroad that they might activate in this regard. From this perspective, it is unclear whether course credits are recognised outside of Jouf University or follow national or international standards (such as the European Credit Transfer System or ECTS) to facilitate ingoing and outgoing student mobility.

The pedagogical organisation of the study programme content is consistent with the needs of the socio-economic sector. This is notably achieved through the mandatory internship in semester 8, which can now cover both semesters 7 and 8. The programme has a partnership with a major local hospital to facilitate internship opportunities, as well as long-standing ties with local schools and translation and tourism agencies and structures. Most internship opportunities are developed by the programme and its staff before being advertised to students, but the programme also welcomes individual student initiatives. The programme also aligns with the needs of the socio-economic sector by integrating representatives from the private sector into the Advisory Board and incorporating their feedback to strengthen student employability. While the programme does not offer continuing education, it has identified this as a future development priority in response to growing national demand for English-language qualifications and in alignment with Saudi Vision 2030.

Overall, the study plan is logically structured, coherent, and progressive, effectively enabling students to achieve targeted skills, facilitate career choices, and foster success. Curriculum design, learning objectives, and assessment criteria are made publicly available through the course student handbook and familiar to all stakeholders. The programme's diversity of learning methods ensures student success, even though more emphasis could be placed on student autonomy through reverse pedagogy and partial distance learning tools. The programme is also encouraged to think about ways of mitigating the risk of failing students in light of the implementation and perpetuation of the new, nationwide recruitment platform. One of the programme's main strengths is its tight structure of academic mentoring, which ensures the monitoring of students' progress and fosters their success and their employability. Yet, this structure relies too much on individual guidance, and the programme might benefit from identifying more clearly student pathways as tracks towards possible specialisation and professionalisation, without relinquishing its current flexibility and allowing for bridges between programmes within the University. Finally, the programme's pedagogical organisation is satisfactorily attuned to the needs of the socio-economic sector through its close ties with local economic actors to ensure internship opportunities.

FIELD 3 – STUDENTS' PATHWAY

The programme provides strong academic guidance supported by highly committed staff, while the formal presentation of pathways and external visibility could be further enhanced. Admission is organised at the national level through an electronic platform, ensuring fairness and transparency for all applicants. Orientation sessions at the beginning of the academic year facilitate smooth integration and provide students with clear information on expectations, regulations, and available support. Each student benefits from personalised academic advising, and faculty members are widely recognised for their availability, collegial spirit, and commitment to student development. This close relationship between staff and students is a major strength of the programme. At the same time, the student population is predominantly local and female, which reflects strong regional visibility, although broadening the profile of incoming students could further enrich the learning environment. Selectivity for admission to the Bachelor's programme has increased, with an acceptance rate of 71.2% in 2020 for 399 applicants, compared to only 47.2% for 123 applicants in 2023. This reflects the implementation of a stronger selection strategy at the programme's entry stage. However, the threefold decrease in the number of applicants over just four years is a cause for concern. While the number of male applicants has remained stable between 2021 and 2023, the number of female applicants has declined year after year. Efforts should therefore be made to reverse this trend in order to avoid a potential reduction in the programme's selectivity in the future. While the programme proposes three recommended tracks (linguistics, literature and translation), these are not yet fully formalised or clearly presented, which may limit students' long-term planning. The programme has already initiated reflections on redefining elective and minor courses, and

aligning the tracks more explicitly within this emerging framework could strengthen academic coherence and help students build clearer professional identities. Overall, while the programme is well positioned to further consolidate student support by capitalising on its strong guidance culture and enhancing the clarity and promotion of its pathways, particular attention should be paid to maintaining and strengthening its overall attractiveness.

Student success is supported by a robust monitoring system, flexible academic arrangements, and highly favourable study conditions, while the development of structured remediation, progressive sequencing, and student autonomy could further reinforce outcomes. The programme closely monitors students' progress through automatic alert systems and proactive mentoring. Tutors provide tailored support via workshops, peer learning, and individual meetings, including through Blackboard and messaging tools. Flexible mechanisms such as adjusted credit loads, resit examinations, and the possibility to repeat a year demonstrate a clear commitment to inclusion and achievement. However, one crucial piece of information is missing from the committee's assessment: the student success rates for each academic year and at graduation over a four- or five-year period (including repeat years). Nevertheless, we are in possession of the cohorts' completion rates: it stood at 39% over four years in 2020–2021 and at 41% in 2023–2024. When we include those students who subsequently graduated within six years, the 2020–2021 cohort reaches a completion rate of 72%, while for the 2023–2024 cohort, the five-year completion rate rises to 91%. Thus, although the five-year and overall completion rates of the cohorts have improved in a positive trajectory in recent years, the four-year rate has remained stagnant. In light of the declining enrolment in the programme, we should expect to see a more marked increase in the four-year completion rate of the bachelor's degree.

In addition to national provisions, the programme shows local responsiveness by offering individual solutions to students facing specific personal or financial difficulties. The institution also provides free tuition, housing, healthcare, transportation, and monthly stipends, creating highly favourable conditions for learning. Beyond academic support, student initiatives such as the Literature and Translation Club contribute to a vibrant campus environment. Encouraging further diversification of extracurricular activities could foster autonomy, leadership, and community engagement. Student feedback is collected through compulsory surveys, and recurring observations lead to adjustments at programme level, reflecting attention to student experience. Some support mechanisms could nevertheless be clarified to better address the diversity of student profiles. Currently, high school results are used to estimate language proficiency; introducing a more systematic diagnostic approach could help identify students who might benefit from targeted support. Similarly, ensuring a more gradual progression in certain course sequences—particularly in translation—would help students consolidate their skills step by step. By continuing to formalise remediation strategies, clarifying course progression, and promoting student autonomy, the programme can build on its strong foundations and further enhance student success.

The programme actively promotes employability and further study through internships, career events, and internationally experienced faculty, and could further strengthen this dynamic by expanding opportunities, deepening partnerships and structuring graduate follow-up. A compulsory 120-hour internship in the final year provides students with valuable exposure to professional environments such as schools, translation agencies and hospitals. The internship is normally scheduled in Level 8 but can also be completed in Level 7, offering greater flexibility and, in some cases, the opportunity to gain up to six months or even a full year of professional experience. The programme also supports students in finding placements through institutional contacts and dedicated activities such as the Career Day, which connects them with public, private, and non-profit partners through workshops and networking sessions. The employability rate after graduation stands at 43% in 2023, which is 2% above the national average. This result illustrates the programme's good performance in facilitating the successful integration of its cohorts at the national level. Graduates successfully pursue further studies locally and abroad and secure employment in education, translation and international schools, demonstrating the relevance of the programme's outcomes. The international background of the faculty further enriches students' perspectives on postgraduate and professional opportunities. Building on these strengths, there is an opportunity to broaden the range of professional experiences available to students. While internships are effective, they are currently concentrated in a limited number of sectors; expanding partnerships to areas such as tourism or public and cultural institutions could offer additional career perspectives aligned with national development priorities. The recommended tracks already reflect clear academic and professional orientations; encouraging students to follow them in a more structured way, rather than selecting courses too freely, could strengthen coherence and support clearer skill development. As the programme anticipates further development of international mobility, preparing structured academic, administrative and financial support mechanisms in advance would help ensure successful implementation and wider participation. Finally, developing a more systematic follow-up of graduate outcomes would provide valuable insights for continuous improvement and forward planning. By progressively diversifying experiential opportunities, encouraging coherent use of academic pathways, anticipating mobility development, and strengthening alumni tracking, the programme can further consolidate its positive impact on employability and further study while adapting to evolving labour market needs.

The programme offers a coherent and student-centred pathway supported by strong academic guidance. While the commitment of faculty and the quality of the learning environment contribute positively to student

achievement, the committee expresses concern over the stagnation of four-year graduation rates, despite the improvements observed over five years and beyond. The monitoring system, credit flexibility, and welfare provisions demonstrate a genuine concern for inclusion and achievement. Initiatives such as the compulsory internship and Career Day create meaningful links with the professional world, and graduates successfully pursue employment and further studies. At the same time, further clarifying and promoting the academic tracks, strengthening remediation mechanisms, and continuing to ensure progressive course sequencing would reinforce academic coherence. Expanding student mobility, diversifying internship opportunities—including potential placements during summer breaks and abroad—and developing a more systematic follow-up of alumni would also enhance the professional and international dimension of the pathway. In the context of ongoing national structural changes, maintaining clarity in programme organisation and student pathways will be key to preserving coherence and supporting transitions. Building on its strong foundations and its clear willingness to evolve, the programme is well positioned to continue improving and to anticipate future academic, societal, and labour market developments in a proactive and strategic manner.

FIELD 4 – ACADEMIC PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

The programme is managed within a structured, transparent, and participatory governance framework that ensures both coherence and accountability, although equity adjustments remain necessary. The teaching team is formally identified and integrated within a clear organisational structure. Responsibilities are distributed among the programme coordinator, the department council, the advisory board, and course coordinators. The department council, which meets more than twenty times per year, plays an active role in monitoring, although the frequency of meetings may at times raise concerns about redundancy. Meeting minutes allow for effective decision tracking. The advisory board adds further value by monitoring both academic standards and labour market relevance. Roles and responsibilities are clearly defined: course coordinators are appointed each semester with explicit mandates, and transparency is reinforced by publishing staff lists, teaching loads, and CVs online. No external contributors currently intervene in teaching. However, an imbalance remains between male and female staff: PhD holders are more numerous among men (23 male and 14 female staff), and student-to-PhD holders ratios are more favourable to male students (1:3) than to female students (1:10). Correcting these imbalances would strengthen equity and overall effectiveness. We noted that, among the twelve sponsored PhD candidates, nine are women. This will be highly beneficial in achieving a more balanced gender ratio.

The programme is supported by adequate human, pedagogical, and administrative resources; however, the limited availability of library holdings in literature may somewhat restrict its full potential. Jouf University ensures the provision of adequate academic resources each semester. The Teaching Load Policy supports a balanced workload distribution of workload. Infrastructures include well-equipped classrooms and offices, with dedicated administrative staff. Digital platforms such as Blackboard and Tayseer enhance programme monitoring and communication. The library provides access to online resources; however, the physical English-language collection remains limited, focused on grammar and medical texts, with little representation of Anglophone literature.

Faculty development and international exposure are supported by regular training opportunities, but outgoing mobility remains limited. An annual training plan strengthens teaching and academic skills, with documented participation. Peer exchanges further disseminate good practices. Orientation sessions assist new staff, and the international diversity of the teaching team enriches perspectives. Despite these strengths, outgoing mobility for faculty remains weak, limiting opportunities for international networking and research integration.

Systematic internal and external evaluation underpins continuous improvement, though the monitoring of actions but communication among stakeholders could be further formalised. Students evaluate courses each semester; results are analysed by the Quality Committee and lead to improvement actions such as bibliographic updates or methodological adjustments. However, impact indicators to measure the effectiveness of these actions are lacking. The advisory board, composed of academics, alumni, and external partners, contributes to curriculum relevance, though the formalisation of follow-up mechanisms for its recommendations remains necessary. External evaluations by NCAAA and Qiyas (latest cycle 2021/2022) have already led to the introduction of new interdisciplinary courses and practical internships, with positive results. A more precise timetable for external evaluations and structured follow-up processes would help consolidate these gains.

The programme consistently upholds quality and ethics through transparent recruitment, rigorous evaluation procedures, and robust anti-plagiarism policies. Admission procedures are clearly documented and accessible online. Standardised assessment procedures guarantee fairness and integrity. Learning outcomes are monitored through structured annual reports. Student evaluations are transparent and accessible via the academic portal.

Academic integrity is safeguarded through systematic plagiarism detection (SafeAssign) and well-documented disciplinary procedures.

The programme demonstrates solid and transparent governance, sufficient human and material resources, and a strong commitment to quality and ethics. Its internal and external evaluation systems ensure a continuous improvement dynamic, while the advisory board enhances its responsiveness to academic and professional needs. Nevertheless, equity imbalances in staffing and student supervision, limited physical library resources, and weak outgoing mobility represent areas requiring targeted action. It is recommended to address staff and supervision disparities through strategic recruitment and resource redistribution, expand the English-language library collection by integrating literary and cultural works, strengthen outgoing mobility by developing institutional partnerships and mobility incentives, and to formalise the monitoring of advisory board and student evaluation recommendations through measurable indicators. By acting on these points, the programme will consolidate its strengths and reinforce its international positioning, thereby fully meeting the fourth accreditation criterion.

VI. CONCLUSION

The *Bachelor of English* programme at Jouf University is strongly aligned with the University's strategic goals and with Saudi Vision 2030, emphasising quality, employability, and academic excellence. Its learning outcomes correspond to the National Qualifications Framework and address nationally identified skills needs. The programme is coherent and comprehensive, covering the main areas of English Studies (linguistics, translation, and literature) and comparable to national and international standards.

However, sustainable development remains marginal, despite its regional and national importance. The programme could integrate *environmental humanities* more systematically to strengthen its contribution to sustainability goals. It would also benefit from closer collaboration with other Saudi universities and international partners to reduce its relative institutional isolation and enhance both student and staff mobility.

The faculty's international background is a major asset, but the programme has yet to leverage this strength to establish a structured partnerships abroad, as student mobility remains underdeveloped. Research is well embedded into teaching and the programme maintains strong links with the labour market through internships and skill-based learning, which provide valuable real-world experience.

The pedagogical progression of the programme is coherently designed across eight semesters, ensuring steady skill development. The curriculum's flexibility fosters autonomy, but the absence of formal specialisation tracks means that student pathways depend heavily on individual advising. Clarifying career-oriented options and introducing a research-focused track would strengthen the programme's coherence and improve graduate prospects.

While the staff's primary focus is the Bachelor of English, some members also provide English-language courses to students from other disciplines. This growing external demand could, in time, challenge the disciplinary identity of the programme. The creation of a separate Language Learning Centre, dedicated to English-language instruction to non-specialist students from other departments and colleges, could help the programme maintain its character as an English Studies degree while offering adapted courses to external learners.

Teaching methods are diverse (lectures, projects, group work, and lab sessions) but could be further expanded through the development of reverse pedagogy and partial distance learning. The programme ensures English proficiency and prepares for IELTS, TOEFL, and national *Jahezia* exams but could strengthen employability by including additional foreign language courses and by introducing a mandatory English certification in the final year.

The programme benefits from highly committed faculty and strong academic support structures. Admission is nationally managed through a transparent platform, and orientation sessions facilitate student integration. The close student-faculty relationship is a major strength, with a mentoring ratio of approximately 1:6. The declining number of applicants—particularly among women—raises concerns about long-term attractiveness. Changing recruitment policies at national level may require enhanced support for underperforming students.

While recommended pathways (Linguistics, Literature, Translation) exist, they are not fully formalised or clearly communicated, which may limit students' ability to plan ahead. Strengthening the visibility and coherence of these tracks could enhance both academic and professional identity. Student success is fostered through proactive mentoring, flexible arrangements, and strong institutional welfare provisions. Yet, despite the improvements observed over five years and beyond, the four-year graduation rate has effectively stagnated, rising only from 39% (2020–21) to 41% (2023–24), and a stronger emphasis on remediation strategies would help to reduce the number of years needed to obtain the diploma.

Employability results are encouraging, with a 43% employment rate, two points above the national average. Internships, Career Day, and the internationally experienced faculty strengthen connections to the labour market. However, internship opportunities remain concentrated in a few sectors, and alumni follow-up is limited. Expanding professional partnerships and international mobility options would enhance the programme's impact and relevance.

The Bachelor of English at Jouf University is managed through a transparent and participatory governance structure that ensures coherence, accountability, and continuous monitoring. The advisory board plays a valuable role in maintaining both academic standards and professional relevance. Responsibilities are clearly distributed among the programme coordinator, the department council, the advisory board, and course coordinators. Decision-making is well documented, although the high frequency of departmental meetings may occasionally lead to redundancy.

Human and pedagogical resources are adequate, but gender and qualification imbalances persist among staff, with male students benefiting from a lower student-to-PhD ratio than female students. The forthcoming integration of female PhD candidates should improve equity. Facilities and digital infrastructure are satisfactory, though the limited English-language library holdings (particularly in literature) may constrain the programme's academic potential. Faculty development is encouraged through regular training and peer exchange, yet outgoing mobility remains limited, restricting international engagement.

Continuous improvement is supported by internal and external evaluations. Quality assurance processes are transparent and robust, with clearly defined recruitment standards, fair assessment procedures, and strong academic integrity safeguards using plagiarism detection systems.

Overall, the Bachelor of English programme at Jouf University demonstrates strong institutional alignment, a clear academic identity, and a sustained commitment to quality and employability. It is supported by a dedicated faculty, robust mentoring practices, and transparent governance. Areas for improvement include the formalisation of academic pathways, the expansion of partnerships and mobility, and the reinforcement of student success and inclusion mechanisms. By consolidating these developments, the programme is well positioned to further strengthen its national and international standing.

STRENGTHS

- Clear institutional alignment and strong quality assurance culture with high ethical standards and commitment to excellence;
- Well-established evaluation culture, with regular student feedback collected each semester and used systematically at programme, college, and university levels;
- Coherent curriculum structure and transparent admission process;
- Developed research engagement at the graduate level: students contribute to research through collaborative papers;
- Highly qualified staff and a genuine openness to international experience at PhD level, with returning scholars bringing varied perspectives and backgrounds to the programme.
- Strong employability focus and solid local partnerships with local stakeholders;
- Excellent study conditions, supported by strong infrastructure and comprehensive student services (scholarship, housing, medical care, sports facilities, etc.).

WEAKNESSES

- Declining graduation rates and a reduced number of applicants which, despite being linked to a selective admissions policy, could weaken the programme in the longer term;
- Low graduation levels within cohorts: the four-year completion rate has shown only minimal improvement, even as the number of students being supervised has declined, and therefore remains below what would reasonably be expected. Absence of post-graduation continuity towards a defined Master's pathway, which would strengthen recruitment quality and support future research prospects at Jouf University;
- Limited structural specialisation, leading to unclear academic tracks and insufficient content progression to reinforce programme identity;
- Weak external partnerships and limited student mobility before the PhD level;
- Insufficient anticipation of the growing demand for English courses from other colleges, which may increasingly divert teaching resources;
- Uneven library resources, with holdings focused on language skills (grammar, pronunciation, TOEFL preparation) rather than on core programme components (linguistics, literature, translation);

- Limited integration of sustainability principles, with no clear description of their impact on the programme.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- The programme's current selectivity and commitment to excellence are commendable. However, given the recent national reorganisation of student admissions, the profile of incoming students may change and could require greater openness to less selective cohorts. In this context, the programme's strong mentoring culture and personalised guidance are valuable assets for supporting students who may need to strengthen their competencies. The University has significant potential to assist motivated students with clear professional aspirations, even if their initial academic performance is modest. However, the current quality of mentoring, while addressing selected students, is not reflected in the final success rate in four years, which has stagnated considering the cohort size and selection intake. A reflexion may be required to understand the causes of the actual low success rates in 4 years, even though improvements have been observed over five years and beyond.
- The programme would benefit from greater visibility by clearly publicising the different academic tracks, ideally starting in the third or fourth year. A clearer distinction between professional and research-oriented outcomes would also be advantageous, as the programme currently attracts two distinct student profiles. Integrating a research dimension would further provide a more structured pathway towards postgraduate (Master's) studies.
- It is recommended that the programme develops a strategic approach to TESOL and to the emerging needs of students from other disciplines. Discussions have indicated growing demand for English proficiency among non-specialist students. Anticipating this evolution will be crucial to prevent fragmentation of teaching responsibilities across staff.
- The establishment of a dedicated Language Learning Centre, serving the English language training needs of other departments and colleges, could enable the programme to maintain its disciplinary identity as an English Studies degree while optimising the delivery of general English language instruction for non-specialists. Such a centre could also offer additional foreign languages options.
- The programme could benefit from the creation of a dedicated office for internationalisation and partnerships. This structure would facilitate the establishment of formal agreements beyond individual academic contacts, and support the organisation of international internships, particularly during summer sessions, through institutional coordination.
- To address the lack of clear operational action on sustainability actions, the programme should integrate environmental humanities and sustainability awareness into its curriculum to strengthen its contribution to the University's and Kingdom's sustainability goals.

VII. COMMENTS OF THE INSTITUTION



November 27th, 2025

Subject: Observations on the Evaluation Report – Bachelor in English Language

Dear Professor Chevallier,
Dear Members of the Evaluation Committee,

On behalf of Jouf University and the College of Arts, I would like to express our sincere appreciation for the professionalism and clarity that characterised the evaluation process. The report provides a balanced and well-informed assessment of the Bachelor in English Language and reflects a clear understanding of the programme within its academic and regional context. We are grateful for both the recognition of strengths and the constructive suggestions for further enhancement.

We note the committee's observation regarding the visibility of sustainable development in the curriculum. While relevant themes are already present across several modules, the department has initiated steps to reinforce their integration in line with national priorities.

Regarding programme coherence, we acknowledge the recommendation related to academic tracks. The current structure already offers students sufficient flexibility; however, the department is considering the introduction of optional pathways to provide additional clarity where useful.

Concerning student progression, we appreciate the committee's remarks. When analysed through the HCERES cohort method, completion rates remain stable and encouraging across cohorts. The four-year completion pattern reflects structural conditions affecting the study cycle, and when viewed across the full study cycle—as standard in HCERES practice—progression is positive.

We also agree on the importance of expanding student mobility. The College is establishing an Internationalisation Unit to coordinate partnerships and mobility opportunities in accordance with institutional priorities.

The comments on library resources and faculty composition are well taken. Acquisition plans and staff development initiatives are already underway to strengthen these areas.

We thank the HCERES committee for its rigorous and constructive evaluation. The report aligns closely with our vision for the programme's continued development, and its recommendations have already informed our internal quality assurance processes. Jouf University remains firmly committed to enhancing the Bachelor in English Language in service of its students and the wider region.

Please accept, Professor Chevallier, the assurance of our highest respect and warm regards,

Dr. Mamdouh Alhuwaykim
Programme Coordinator
Bachelor in English Language
College of Arts, Jouf University

The evaluation reports of Hceres
are available online : www.hceres.fr/en

Evaluation of higher education and research institutions

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International evaluation and accreditation



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International evaluation and accreditation

ACCREDITATION DECISION

Bachelor in English Language

College of Arts

Jouf University

Sakakah

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

December 2025

SCOPE OF THE ACCREDITATION GRANTED BY HCERES

Hcéres has based its evaluation process on a set of objectives that higher education institution study programs must pursue to ensure recognised quality in France and Europe. These objectives are divided into four areas common to both the evaluation framework and the accreditation criteria.

The Accreditation Commission issues an opinion on the accreditation of the program after examining the application. The Hcéres President takes the decision based on this opinion and the final evaluation report of the program. This accreditation decision, taken in plenary session, is the result of a collegial and reasoned process.

The decision issued by Hcéres regarding the accreditation of the program corresponds to the award of a label, on behalf of Hcéres, to the evaluated entity.

This decision is independent of the accreditations carried out by the French State and therefore does not entail recognition in France of the diplomas delivered by the institution.

Decision No. EI-2025-16 on the accreditation of the Bachelor in English Language delivered by College of Arts, Jouf University, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

The President of the High Council for the Evaluation of Research and Higher Education,

Considering the Research Code, in particular Articles L. 114-3-1 to L. 114-3-6;

Considering the Decree No. 2021-1536 of 29 November 2021 on the organisation and operation of the High Council for the Evaluation of Research and Higher Education;

Considering the Board's deliberation No. 2022-5-02 of 29 September 2022 on the accreditation criteria for international study programmes (Except for doctorates/PhDs);

Considering the Decision No. 2023-9 of 16 March 2023 on the international accreditation procedure of the High Council for the Evaluation of Research and Higher Education;

Considering the agreement No. DEI_2025_CONV10 - for the evaluation/accreditation of Bachelor in English Language, College of Arts, Jouf University, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia;

Considering the opinion issued by the Accreditation Commission on December 12th 2025,

Decides:

Article 1

Having determined that the Bachelor in English Language delivered by College of Arts, Jouf University, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia meets the four accreditation criteria, voted by the Board of the High Council on 29 September 2022, as follows:

ACCREDITATION CRITERION 1: TEACHING POLICY AND CHARACTERISATION

The teaching policy and learning objectives of the study programme are clearly aligned with the institution's strategic priorities of developing student skills to improve employability and career prospects, as well as to enable graduates to pursue further study at the postgraduate level. The Bachelor of English convincingly demonstrates its disciplinary identity as an English studies programme and leverages the experience of the teaching staff to reflect international standards. It could however benefit from strengthening and expanding its international dimension through collaborations and partnerships to enable student and staff mobility. Additionally, the programme maintains close links with the local economic sector, while introducing students to research methodologies, thus preparing them to enrol in MA programmes, should they wish to do so. The programme could nevertheless benefit from identifying more clearly thematic or professional tracks to facilitate students' career choice. Current and future institutional changes at the level of the College and the University represent opportunities of expansion for the programme through the development of English-language courses for students of other disciplines, as well as challenges to maintain its characterization as an English Studies programme.

ACCREDITATION CRITERION 2: THE PEDAGOGICAL ORGANISATION OF THE STUDY PROGRAM

The study plan is logically structured, coherent, and progressive, effectively enabling students to achieve targeted skills, facilitate career choices, and foster success. Curriculum design, learning objectives, and assessment criteria are made publicly available through the course student handbook and familiar to all stakeholders. The programme's diversity of learning methods ensures student success, even though more emphasis could be placed on student autonomy through reverse pedagogy and partial distance learning tools. The programme is also encouraged to think about ways of mitigating the risk of failing students in light of the implementation and perpetuation of the new, nationwide recruitment platform. One of the programme's main strengths is its tight structure of academic mentoring, which ensures the monitoring of students' progress and fosters their success and their employability. Yet, this structure relies too much on individual guidance, and the programme might benefit from identifying more clearly student pathways as tracks towards possible specialisation and professionalisation, without relinquishing its current flexibility and allowing for bridges between programmes within the University. Finally, the programme's pedagogical organisation is satisfactorily attuned to the needs of the socio-economic sector through its close ties with local economic actors to ensure internship opportunities.

ACCREDITATION CRITERION 3: STUDENTS' PATHWAY

The programme offers a coherent and student-centred pathway supported by strong academic guidance. While the commitment of faculty and the quality of the learning environment contribute positively to student achievement, the committee expresses concern over the stagnation of four-year graduation rates, despite the improvements observed over five years and beyond. The monitoring system, credit flexibility, and welfare provisions demonstrate a genuine concern for inclusion and achievement. Initiatives such as the compulsory internship and Career Day create meaningful links with the professional world, and graduates successfully pursue employment and further studies. At the same time, further clarifying and promoting the academic tracks, strengthening remediation mechanisms, and continuing to ensure progressive course sequencing would reinforce academic coherence. Expanding student mobility, diversifying internship opportunities—including potential placements during summer breaks and abroad—and developing a more systematic follow-up of alumni would also enhance the professional and international dimension of the pathway. In the context of ongoing national structural changes, maintaining clarity in programme organisation and student pathways will be key to preserving coherence and supporting transitions. Building on its strong foundations and its clear willingness to evolve, the programme is well positioned to continue improving and to anticipate future academic, societal, and labour market developments in a proactive and strategic manner.

ACCREDITATION CRITERION 4: MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT OF THE STUDY PROGRAM

The programme demonstrates solid and transparent governance, sufficient human and material resources, and a strong commitment to quality and ethics. Its internal and external evaluation systems ensure a continuous improvement dynamic, while the advisory board enhances its responsiveness to academic and professional needs. Nevertheless, equity imbalances in staffing and student supervision, limited physical library resources, and weak outgoing mobility represent areas requiring targeted action. It is recommended to address staff and supervision disparities through strategic recruitment and resource redistribution, expand the English-language library collection by integrating literary and cultural works, strengthen outgoing mobility by developing institutional partnerships and mobility incentives, and to formalise the monitoring of advisory board and student evaluation recommendations through measurable indicators. By acting on these points, the programme will consolidate its strengths and reinforce its international positioning, thereby fully meeting the fourth accreditation criterion.

Article 2

The Bachelor in English Language delivered by College of Arts of Jouf University, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia is accredited for a period of five years from the date of this decision.

Article 3

The decision is accompanied by the following recommendations:

- The programme's current selectivity and commitment to excellence are commendable. However, given the recent national reorganisation of student admissions, the profile of incoming students may change and could require greater openness to less selective cohorts. In this context, the programme's strong mentoring culture and personalised guidance are valuable assets for supporting students who may need to strengthen their competencies. The University has significant potential to assist motivated students with clear professional aspirations, even if their initial academic performance is modest. However, the current quality of mentoring, while addressing selected students, is not reflected in the final success rate in four years, which has stagnated considering the cohort size and selection intake. A reflexion may be required to understand the causes of the actual low success rates in 4 years, even though improvements have been observed over five years and beyond.
- The programme would benefit from greater visibility by clearly publicising the different academic tracks, ideally starting in the third or fourth year. A clearer distinction between professional and research-oriented outcomes would also be advantageous, as the programme currently attracts two distinct student profiles. Integrating a research dimension would further provide a more structured pathway towards postgraduate (Master's) studies.
- It is recommended that the programme develops a strategic approach to TESOL and to the emerging needs of students from other disciplines. Discussions have indicated growing demand

for English proficiency among non-specialist students. Anticipating this evolution will be crucial to prevent fragmentation of teaching responsibilities across staff.

- The establishment of a dedicated Language Learning Centre, serving the English language training needs of other departments and colleges, could enable the programme to maintain its disciplinary identity as an English Studies degree while optimising the delivery of general English language instruction for non-specialists. Such a centre could also offer additional foreign languages options.
- The programme could benefit from the creation of a dedicated office for internationalisation and partnerships. This structure would facilitate the establishment of formal agreements beyond individual academic contacts, and support the organisation of international internships, particularly during summer sessions, through institutional coordination.
- To address the lack of clear operational action on sustainability actions, the programme should integrate environmental humanities and sustainability awareness into its curriculum to strengthen its contribution to the University's and Kingdom's sustainability goals.

Article 4

This decision will be published on the Hcéres website.

Paris, December 12th 2025

President

signed

Coralie Chevallier

The evaluation reports of Hceres
are available online : www.hceres.fr/en

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